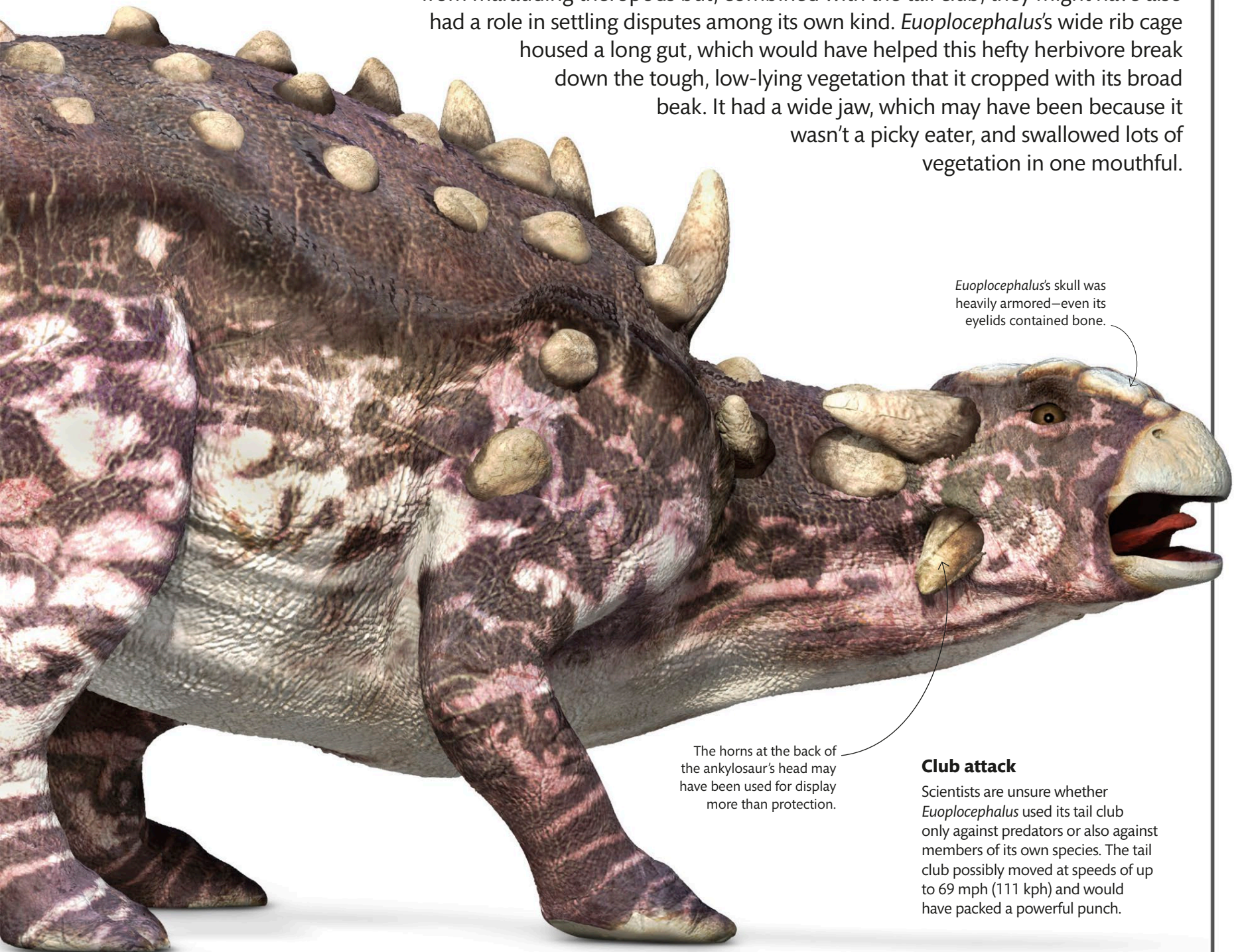


ARMORED TANK

EUOPLOCEPHALUS

One of the best-defended dinosaurs of the Late Cretaceous Period, *Euoplocephalus* was heavily armored and sported a wicked-looking club at the end of its tail. These defenses are often thought to have evolved to help *Euoplocephalus* fend off attacks from marauding theropods but, combined with the tail club, they might have also had a role in settling disputes among its own kind. *Euoplocephalus*'s wide rib cage housed a long gut, which would have helped this hefty herbivore break down the tough, low-lying vegetation that it cropped with its broad beak. It had a wide jaw, which may have been because it wasn't a picky eater, and swallowed lots of vegetation in one mouthful.



Euoplocephalus's skull was heavily armored—even its eyelids contained bone.

The horns at the back of the ankylosaur's head may have been used for display more than protection.

Club attack

Scientists are unsure whether *Euoplocephalus* used its tail club only against predators or also against members of its own species. The tail club possibly moved at speeds of up to 69 mph (111 kph) and would have packed a powerful punch.